

User guide, version 1.2.0

Start

You need Node.js 20 or newer.

See it first. The demo is an invented company in a temporary folder. It never touches your data.

```
node bin/arsenale.cjs demo
```

Install. The installer asks before every change. Add `--dry-run` to see the plan.

Windows	`powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1`
macOS, Linux	`./install.sh`

Run. `arsenale serve` opens `http://localhost:4310` in your browser. `arsenale open` opens it again.

Connect your tools. Open **Settings, Assistants**. Claude Desktop, Claude Code, Cursor, VS Code, Codex CLI, Gemini CLI and Aider each have a card with the exact command. Press **Test**. It turns green when the tool says hello.

> Arsenale only watches. It never starts or stops your assistants.

Finding your way

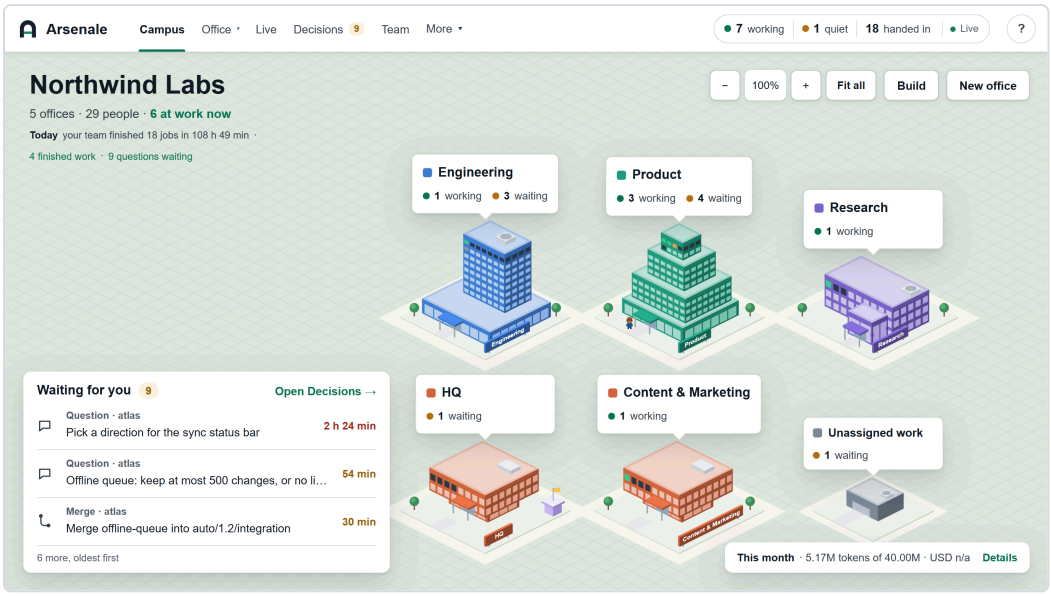
The top bar has five screens: **Campus**, **Office**, **Live**, **Decisions** and **Team**. Everything else is under **More**: Tasks, Finished work, Activity, Org chart, Gate history, Details: tools & usage, Marketplace and Settings.

On the right, one group counts who is working, who is quiet and what was handed in today. The **?** button opens the user guide and shows the legends and notes of the screen you are on. They stay hidden until you ask for them.

Waiting for you is the small card at the bottom left of the campus and the office. It shows the three oldest questions in plain words, and how long each has waited. Click it for the full list.

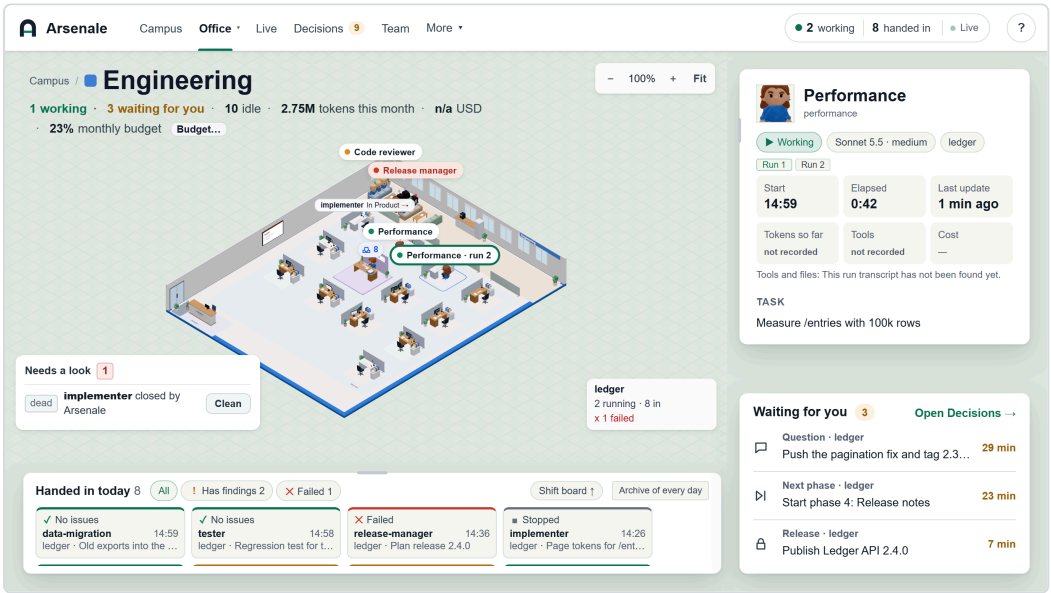
Campus

One building per office, in the office's colour. Each card says who is working and who waits; hover it for the tokens and the budget. Click a building to go in. **Build** lets you place, move, rotate and archive buildings. **New office** adds an office of your own (see Offices).



Office

People sit at their desks and type, walk to the supervisor when they wait for you, and rest in the lounge when they are free. A small pill marks a person who is working, waiting, quiet, stalled or dead. The **Needs a look** box lists them. **Nudge** asks your supervisor to check the run. **Clean** hides a closed run; its log stays.

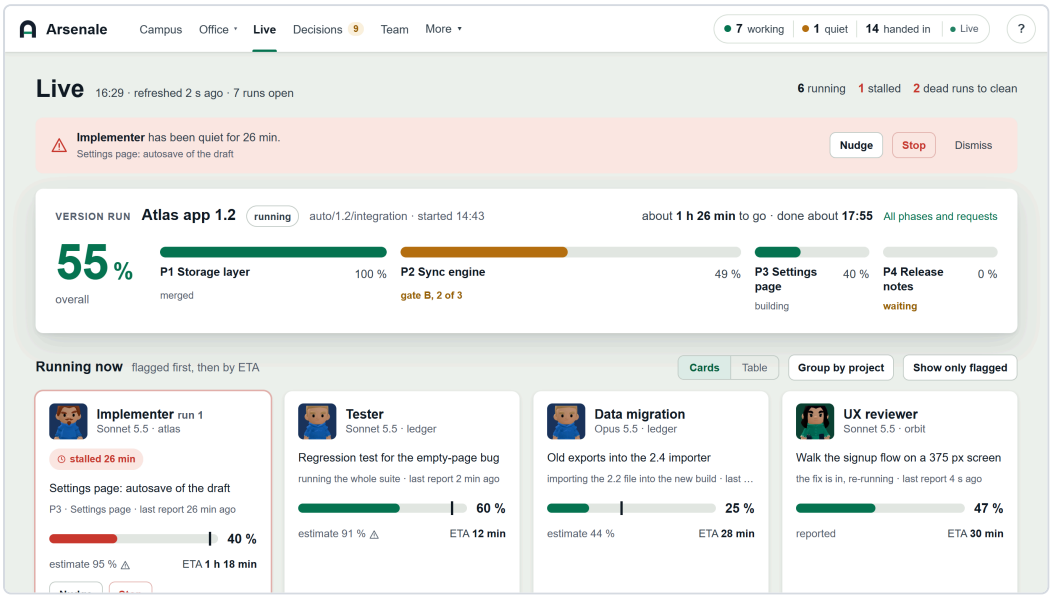


Live

Every run that is working now: the step, a percent, files changed, last activity, time so far and time left. The percent is what the agent reports. Without one, Arsenale estimates it and marks it "est.".

A run quiet for 10 minutes turns amber. At the stall limit (20 minutes) it turns red and a bar appears with **Nudge** and **Stop**. Stop only asks your supervisor to end the run.

Live also shows the test queue and unfinished work.



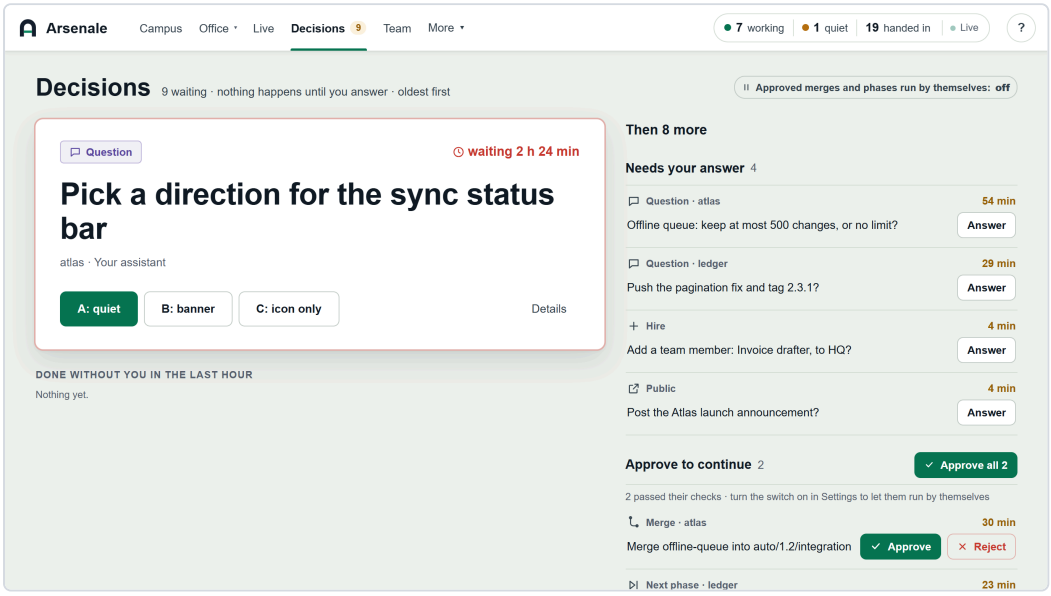
Decisions

Every waiting question and approval, in three columns.

- **Needs your answer.** Questions from your team.
- **Approve to continue.** A merge or a next phase. **Approve all** answers them together.
- **Always waits for you.** Builds and releases.

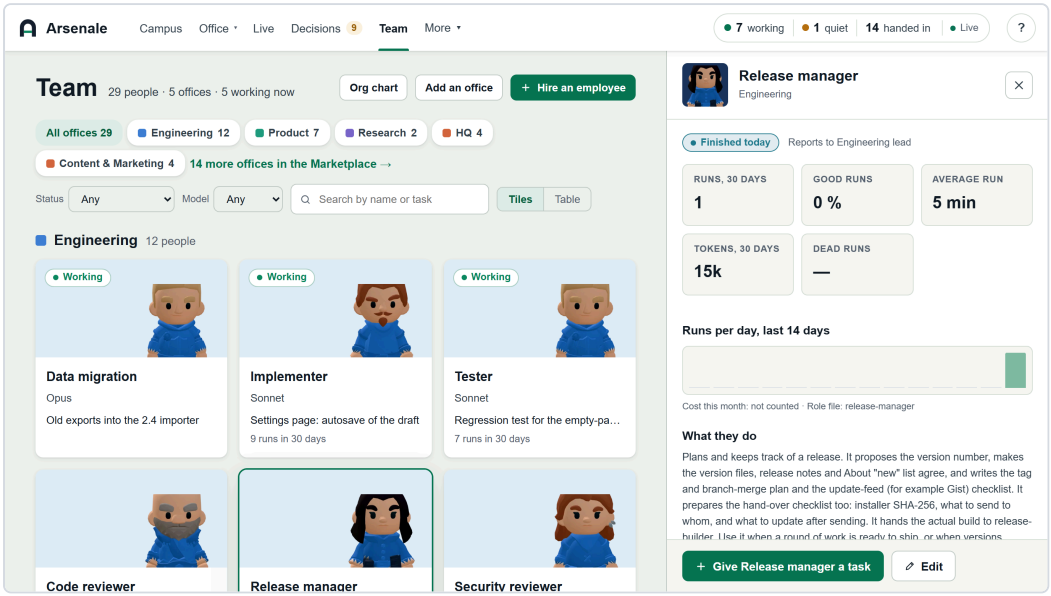
Each card names what is asked in plain words: Question, Merge, Next phase, Build, Release. The buttons are **Approve** and **Reject** everywhere, on the page and on your phone. **Details** shows the evidence. Under the columns, **Done without you** lists what ran by itself in the last hour. **Undo** works once, for 10 minutes.

The switch at the top right, **Approved merges and phases run by themselves**, is off by default. Set it in Settings, Decisions.



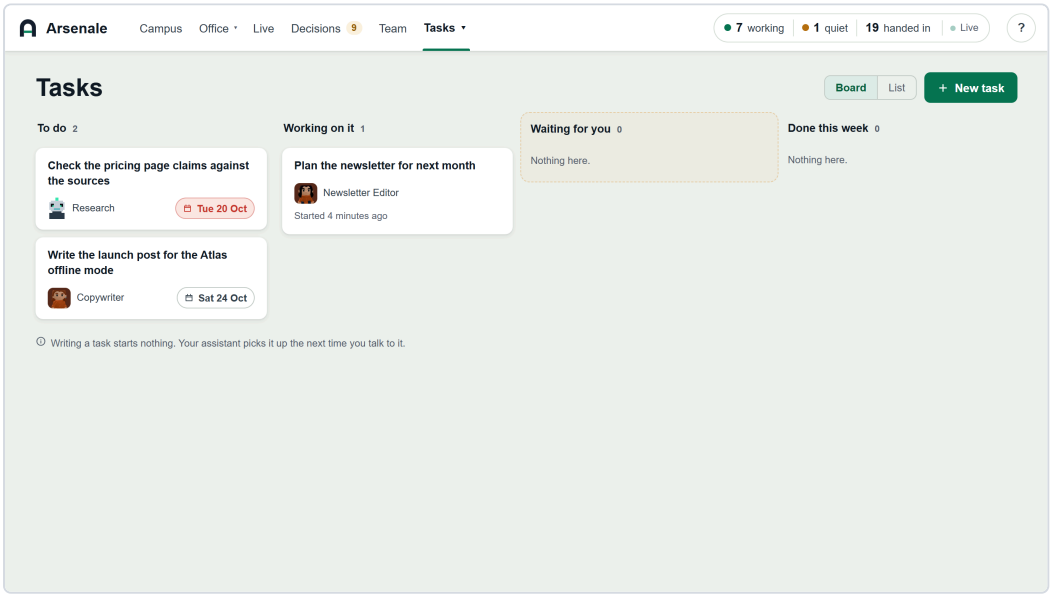
Team

Everyone, grouped by office, as tiles of people or as a table: status, current task, runs, last active. Search, or filter by office, status or model. A tile or a row opens the profile. **Hire an employee** hires someone in plain words. **Add an office** opens the New office form. The packs you have not added are one link, "more offices in the Marketplace".



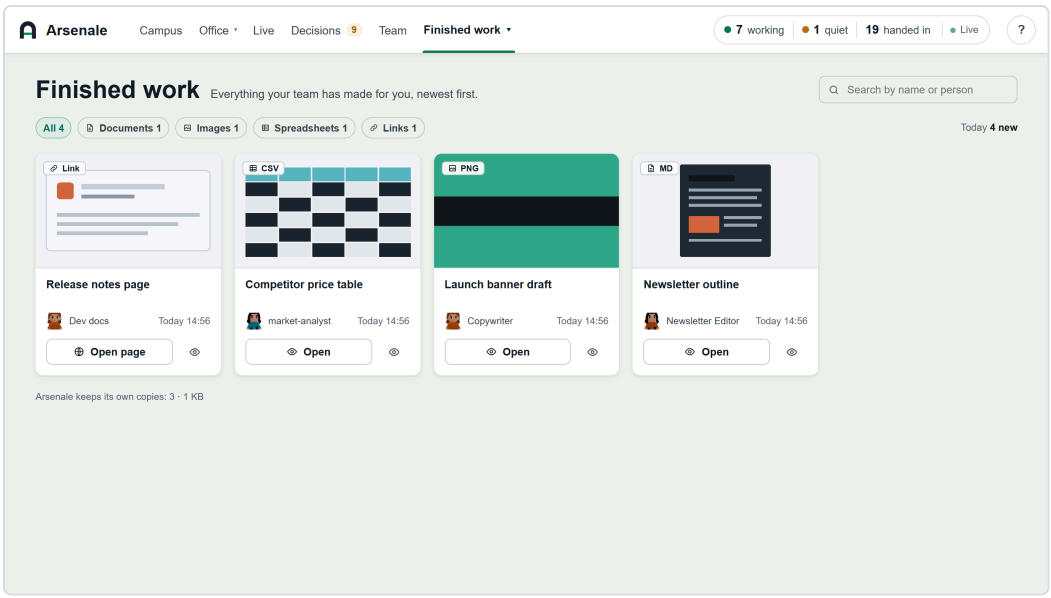
Tasks

A board: To do, Working on it, Waiting for you, Done this week. Or a list. **New task** takes what you need, who should do it and when. Writing a task starts nothing: your assistant picks it up the next time you talk to it.



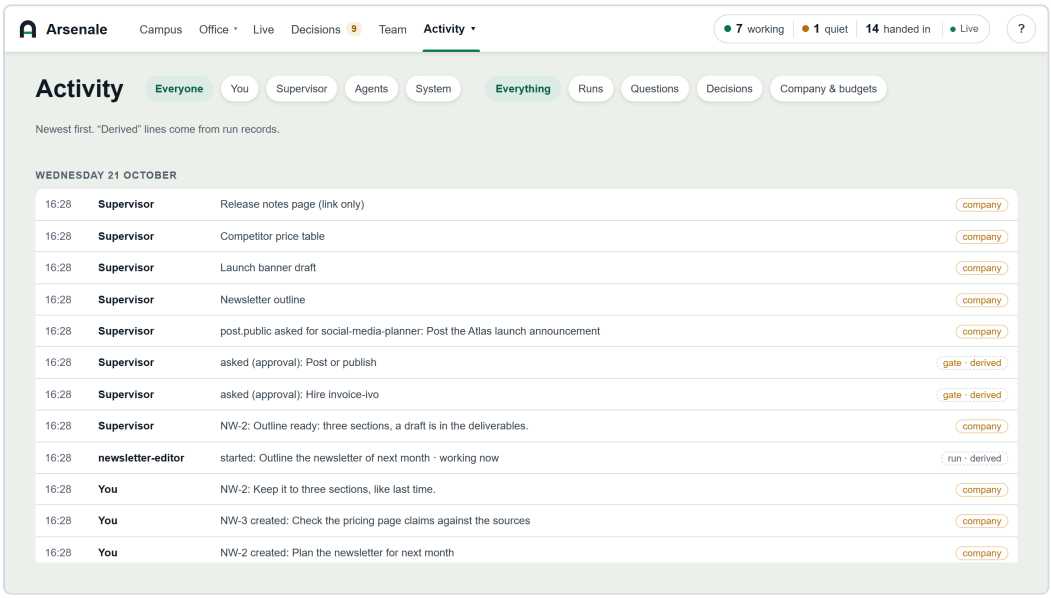
Finished work

Documents, images, spreadsheets and links your team handed in. Search by name or person. Previews come from Arsenale's own copies.



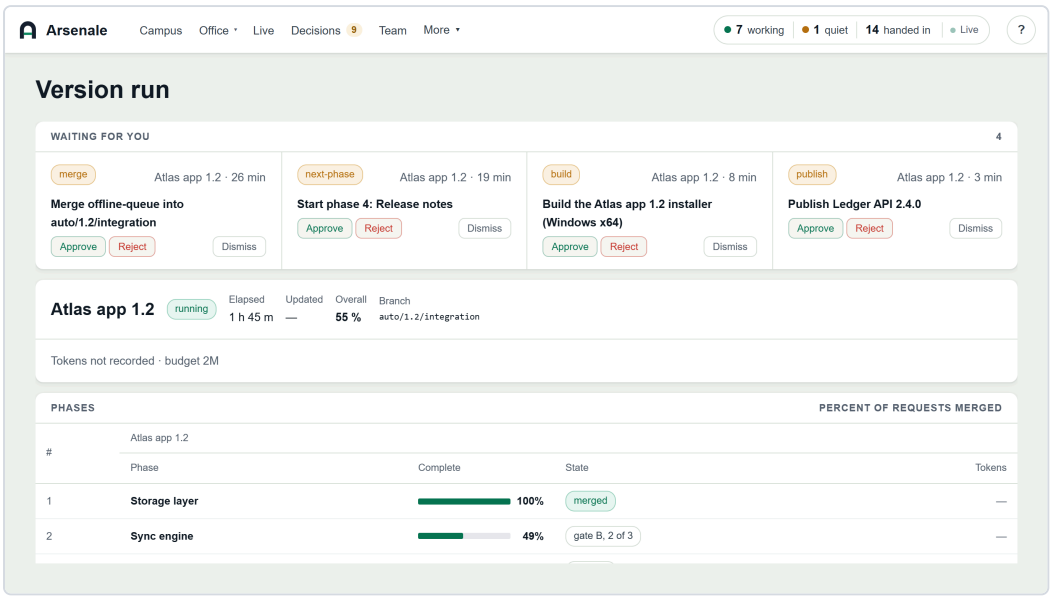
Activity

Who did what and when, grouped by day. Filter it. Closed and stopped runs stay here; nothing is deleted.



Version run

For an autonomous run of a version: its phases, overall percent, agents, token budget and owner gates. Open it with **All phases and requests** on Live.



Gate history

Under **More**. A timeline of who decided what.

Offices

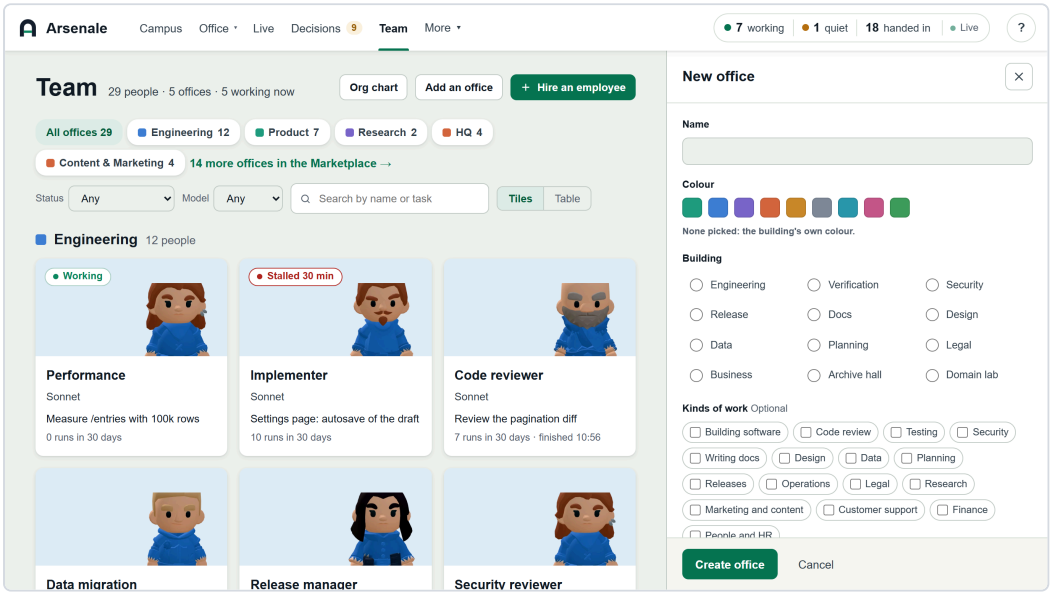
New office (on the campus, next to Build, or **Add an office** on Team) asks for:

- **Name.** Up to 40 characters, not the name of another office.
- **Colour.** One of nine office colours.
- **Building.** One of the 12 building types.
- **Kinds of work.** For example Testing, Code review or Writing docs. Each kind belongs to one office only.

Nothing is saved until you press **Create office**. **Edit office** on Team changes it later. Archiving an office keeps its history.

Where work goes. When a run starts, it goes to the office named for it, else to the office that does its kind of work, else to its project's office, else to the person's home office. That choice is kept with the run, so changing the kinds later never moves past work or past budgets.

> Only you can create, edit or archive an office. Your assistant and its agents cannot.



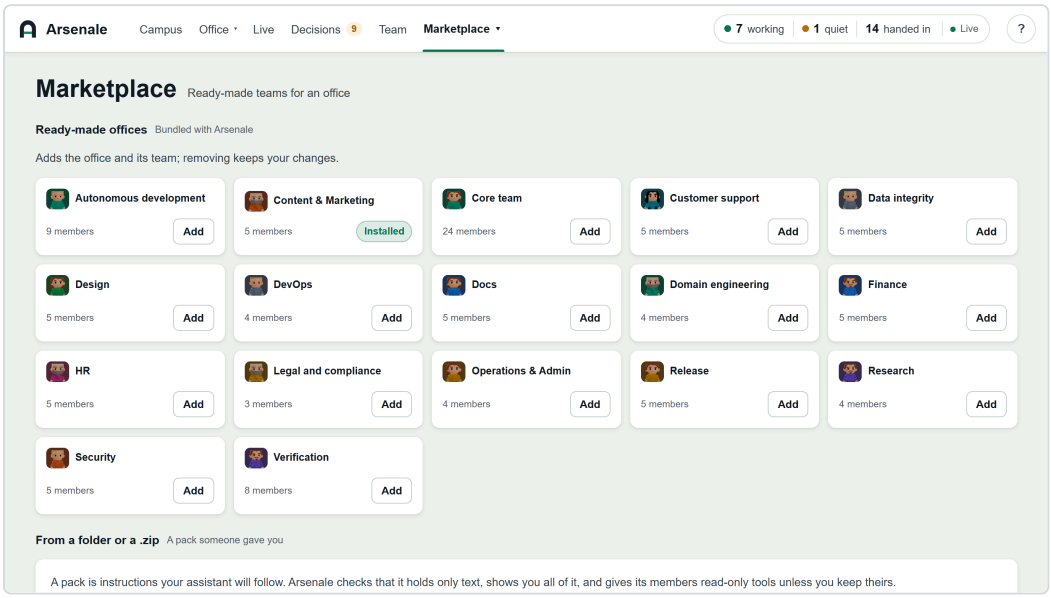
Marketplace

Under **More**. Ready-made offices with their teams.

- **Bundled with Arsenale.** Press **Add**, then **Add this office**. Removing a pack keeps the files you changed.
- **From a folder or a .zip.** A pack someone gave you. Arsenale checks that it holds only text, then shows you all of it: every member, its tools, its full instructions and warnings for anything risky. Nothing is written until you press **Install**.

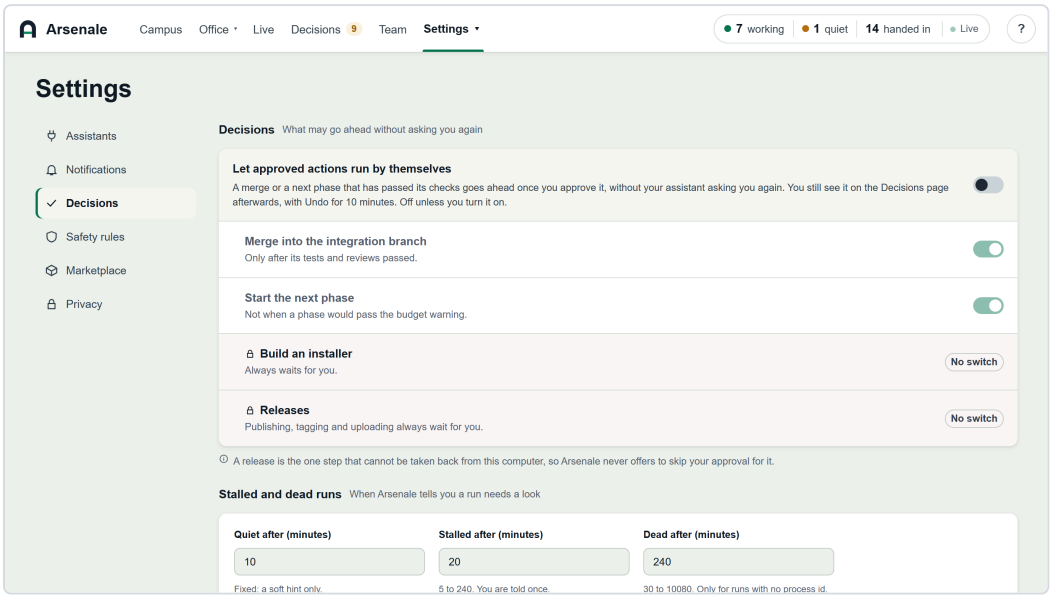
Members of such a pack get read-only tools unless you tick **Keep the pack's tools** for them. The pack is marked "From a folder: not checked by Arsenale".

> A pack is instructions your assistant will follow. The read-only tools line is honoured by Claude Code subagents; other assistants may ignore it. Install only packs you have read.



Settings

- **Assistants.** Connect a tool in three steps, with a Test button.
- **Notifications.** Desktop and phone. See the next section.
- **Decisions.** The auto-run switch, one switch each for merges and next phases, and the limits for a quiet, stalled and dead run.
- **Safety rules.** See Safety.
- **Marketplace.** The ready-made offices (packs) of the Marketplace page, with a link to it. Add a ready-made office, or remove one. Your own files are kept.
- **Privacy.** Everything stays on this computer. No account, no tracking.



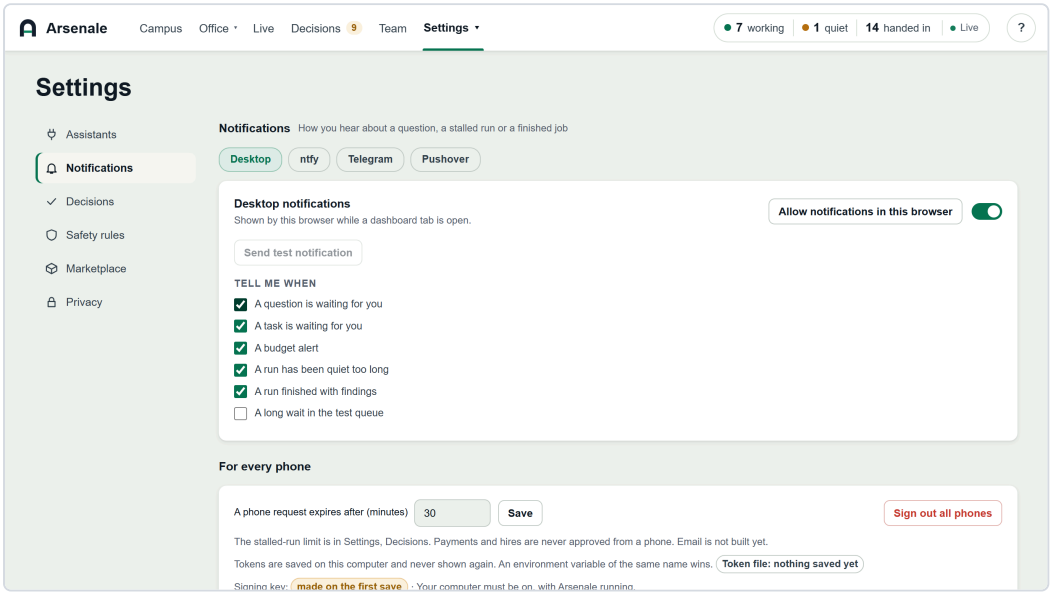
Phone notifications

Settings, Notifications has a tab each for Desktop, ntfy, Telegram and Pushover.

1. Fill in the channel. Tokens are saved in a file only you can read and are never shown again.
2. Press **Save**, then **Send test**.
3. When the test arrives, the channel's switch can go on. It stays off until a test has arrived.

Change a server, topic or token and the channel switches off until the next test arrives. Each channel has its own list of events.

By default a phone message says only that something is waiting. Turn on details to include the question; that shows its text to the service. ntfy and Telegram can carry Approve and Reject. Pushover only notifies. Arsenale must be running on your computer to send.

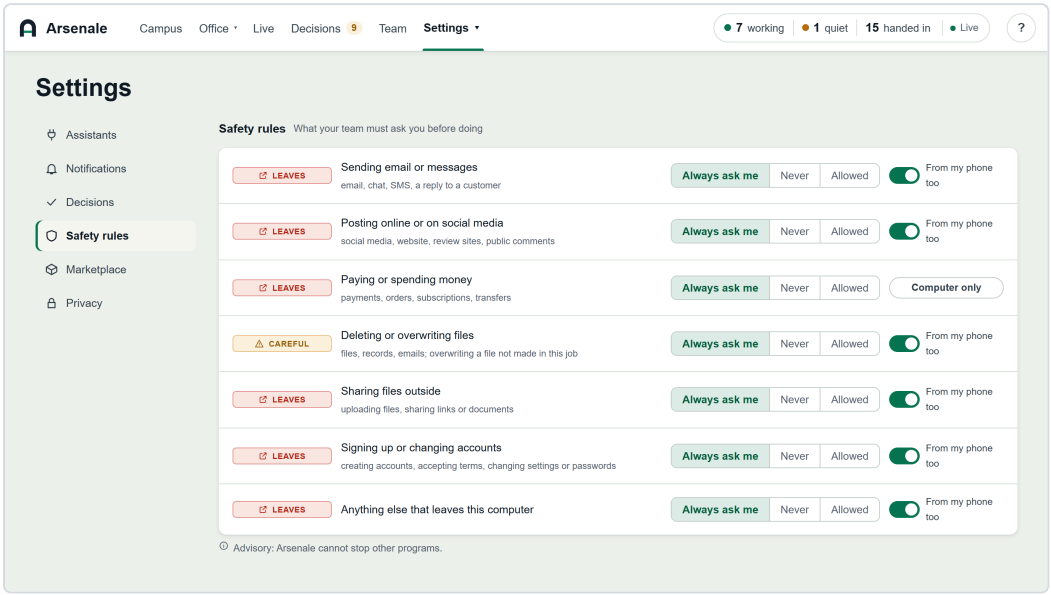


Safety

Builds and releases always wait for you. Building, tagging, publishing or uploading a release is never approved by the auto-run switch and never gets a phone button. Payments and hires are not approved from a phone either.

Settings, Safety rules sets, for each kind of action that leaves your computer, whether it is allowed, must ask you first (the default), or is never allowed.

> These rules are advisory. Arsenale asks your assistant to check and records what happened; it cannot block a tool inside another program.



The test queue

Only one full test suite should run on a machine at a time. A builder runs it like this:

```
arsenale testq run --run <run id> -- <command>
```

It waits its turn, runs the command and exits with its result. `arsenale testq status` shows who holds the suite and who waits. `arsenale testq leave --run <run id>` leaves the queue. A run that waits is not counted as quiet. Live shows the same queue.

After a restart

Run `arsenale resume-scan` at the start of a session. It finds runs that ended without finishing and left changes behind. Live lists them under unfinished work.

- **Resume** sends the stored brief to your supervisor's inbox. It starts nothing.
- **Dismiss** hides the item. Nothing in the worktree is deleted.

Recording a video

Record from the demo, never from your real data:

```
node bin/arsenale.cjs demo --showcase
```

Showcase hides the Waiting for you card, the legends and the notes. You can also switch it under **?** in the demo. In a window 360 to 480 pixels wide each screen has a one-column layout, made for 9:16 video.